

LinkedIn's publishing tool...

...after reaching one million posts by its members, has started its international rollout, giving access to other English speaking countries, including India. <http://dgit.in/LinkdINPub>



Mexican drug drones?

A drone carrying crystal meth crash lands into the parking lot of a supermarket near the US-Mexico border <http://dgit.in/methdrone>

ASUS GTX 980 Matrix Platinum

Pushing the envelope a little further than before



Price
₹52,000

ASUS's ROG cards always give enthusiasts something to look forward to. These cards are made for those who're willing to push the limits and it's no surprise to see their cards occupying four places in the top ten ranking on 3DMark's Hall of Fame with the first place being retained as well.



Performance.....72
Value75
Build68

Specifications

Chipset: GM206; **Base clock:** 1241MHz; **Memory clock:** 1753MHz; **Stream processors:** 2048; **Texture Units:** 128; **ROPs:** 64; **Manufacturing process:** 28nm, PCIe 3.0, 4096 x 2160 digital resolution support, 4 GB Memory; **DirectX support:** 12; **OpenGL support:** 4.4; **Power Connectors:** 8Pin + 8Pin; **TDP:** >165W; **Warranty:** 3 years

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The 980 Matrix platinum has pretty good cooling with load temperatures never going above 53 degrees Celsius but those who do get this card are generally going to be pushing for the leader-boards with the help of LN2. And when it comes to the problems faced by extreme enthusiasts the card has a few well-thought out features like the LN2 defroster which is useful for preventing cold bugs. Also, if you screw up with the BIOS then there is a one button recovery system as well.

We started overclocking the card with the memory clock boosted to 1997.5MHz from 1753MHz and the boost clock was pushed to 1495MHz. The actual speed noted was 1455MHz and that pushed the Firestrike score from 11,861 to 13,277 which is an impressive 12 percent improvement.

If you're wondering why the performance score isn't the maximum for this card it's because we've added the GTX TITAN Z and the AMD R9 295X2 to our benchmarks. Otherwise, this is the best performing single-GPU graphics card that we've tested.

Mithun Mobandas

Lenovo W540

Most powerful business notebook we've tested

The ThinkPad W540 is no ordinary laptop. It's thick, bulky and not for the faint of heart. It's every inch a bore, if dazzlingly beautiful laptops is your thing. But ThinkPads were never built to win beauty contests. The W540 is built like a tank, with metal hinges that give it great rigidity. The workstation-class laptop packs in a fantastic keyboard which is an absolute joy to type on, with island-styled isolated keys. The accompanying track-point navigation is as addictive as ever, something that's guaranteed to make you



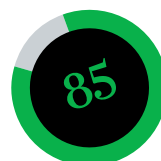
Price
₹1,29,500

forget the traditional touchpad slab found on almost all laptops. These two input options are one of the best we've experienced on a laptop, and the W540's dedicated numpad packs in great convenience for spreadsheet obsessed business executives.

The laptop's screen is matte, which is great for business usage, but it has mediocre viewing angles. Looking at the machine's hardware capability, its performance blows past all business laptops we've tested till December 2014. What's particularly surprising and noteworthy is the laptop's better-than-average loud and clear speakers for a pleasant audio experience. As a business laptop, the W540 comes with Intel vPro and other security features, not to mention proprietary software for easy maintenance of the laptop.

If you're CAD and 3D modelling, definitely consider this laptop. Also check out HP ZBook and Dell Precision M3800 which are pretty good as well.

Jayesh Shinde



Performance.....85
Features85
Build Quality90
Value80

Specifications

Screen: 15.6-inch, no touchscreen, Full HD res; **CPU:** Quad-core Intel Core i7-4800MQ 2.7GHz; **RAM:** 8GB DDR3; **HDD:** 1TB; **GPU:** NVIDIA Quadro K1100M with 2GB GDDR5; **IO Ports:** Thunderbolt, VGA, 4 x USB 3.0, SD Card slot, ExpressCard slot; **Wireless:** Wi-Fi 802.11ac & Bluetooth: 4.0; **Weight:** 2.7 kg

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